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“KKR have issues to sort out. With a coaching team of five, how much time can the head coach spend with the players?”

MICKY ARTHUR, Coach, South Africa

captains. He finally settled for one in Brendon McCullum, and the pressure of the job caused the Kiwi's instant demise as explosive opener.

Players were asked to stay in South Africa and then to leave. One was later asked to return. An anonymous blogger called 'Fake IPL Player' is churning out a malicious account of life 'inside' the team, complete with gossip and wicked nicknames, but as the losses have piled up, even the sedition has begun to sound sombre.

Denying that the blog has had any impact, Team Director Joy Bhattacharjya says, "Stories about infighting are just not true... we're all awake nights wondering what we could have done different." For starters, being able to say 'no' would have helped owners, Shah Rukh and Jai Mehta, who tend to invest all faith

and power in one person with few checks and balances. Catering or coaching, it is how jobs are delegated in KKR. It is why Buchanan, with his gold-plated record and reputation as former coach of world champs Australia, was given full control.

A KKR player said, "There has been one error of judgement after another." The carte blanche to Buchanan may have been the one that started it all. Cricketers—and this is not just the Indians—have found Buchanan "uninspiring". A week after they had arrived, IPL newcomers found they had not been able to interact with Buchanan, crowded in as he was by lieutenants.

Buchanan (fee \$250,000 per year) returned to KKR this season with the Red Army on hand to assist—he had six hand-picked assistants, chief coach Mathew Mott, assistant coach

Brad Murphy, Andy Bichel (bowling), Jon Deeble (fielding), Wade Seccombe (wicket-keeping) and finally, and most damagingly, his son, Michael, assistant coach for strength training. The total wage bill for this staff is also said to be in the region of \$250,000.

South African coach Micky Arthur is amazed, "How much time can the head coach actually spend with the players?" he asks, adding that he himself tried to be as 'hands on' with his players, in order to build rapport and earn respect. Buchanan prefers hands-off. He watches matches from the dressing room, communicating with Mott in the dugout via walkie-talkie. The 'four captains', many believe, was nothing but an attempt to wrest more power for the coach.

"These guys have too many theories," says a KKR player. "We're not